

Bushey Amateur Swimming Club History and Competitive Calendar

Executive summary

The public record is strong enough to verify that Bushey Amateur Swimming Club was founded in **1926**, and that the club's origin point was the **King George V pool / King George Recreation Ground pool** in Bushey. That conclusion is supported by four independent strands: Bushey's own centenary framing for 2026, the club's 2016 AGM minute stating that 2016 was its 90th anniversary, a local Bushey news feature stating that the club "was founded in King George V pool in 1926", and Hertsmere's historical note that the open-air pool at King George Recreation Ground opened in July 1925, which makes a 1926 founding at that site operationally plausible.

What can be reconstructed most clearly after the founding is not a full founder-by-founder chronology, but a sequence of institutional milestones. By the early 2000s the club was already operating from **Bushey Grove Leisure Centre**; today it says it is primarily based there while also using **other local pools**, and its welcome pack names **St Margaret's** among the pool facilities it uses. The current public-facing structure shows **Jane Willis** as club president and **Oliver Spisak** as head coach, with the club explicitly promoting a centenary year in 2026.

The competitive picture is also reasonably clear. Across a conservative five-year evidence window, Bushey appears in a recurring mix of **internal club championships and time trials, county championships, local qualifier and development meets** in the Hertfordshire orbit, occasional **regional championships**, and some **league-based team galas**. The most consistently evidenced external competitions are **Watford-hosted qualifier/development meets, Hertfordshire County Championships, Stevenage development or sprint meets, Peanuts League / Major League / Arena-style team galas**, and **late-autumn county-qualifying meets** such as **Harpenden Last Chance**.

The best estimate for Bushey's next annual cycle is therefore a club season that peaks in **January** for counties, **March to June** for internal racing plus Hertfordshire league activity and development/open meets, **late April to May** for regionals where swimmers qualify, and **November to early December** for county-qualifying open meets and internal championships. Where evidence is incomplete, this report states so explicitly and estimates conservatively.

Historical development

The strongest verified starting point is that Bushey ASC traces itself to **1926**. The club's own materials now frame 2026 as its **centenary**, and the 2015 AGM minute records that "this year will be Bushey swimming club 90th anniversary", which also points back to 1926. A 2016 local news feature adds the key geographical detail: the club "was founded in King George V pool in 1926". Hertsmere's historic leaflet on the recreation ground states that the open-air pool there was opened in **July 1925**, which helps anchor the site history behind the club's origin story.

The exact **founders' names** were **not recoverable** from the publicly accessible official and archival sources surfaced here. None of the accessible Bushey ASC pages, AGM snippets, county reports, or

local-history pages named founders directly. That is an important limit: the founding **year** and **place** are well evidenced, but the founding **people** are not, at least in the indexed public corpus reviewed for this report. This absence should be treated as an evidential gap rather than proof that the names do not survive elsewhere.

The club's **later pool history** is only partially reconstructable. By July 2004, a Bushey ASC newsletter thanked **Bushey Grove Leisure Centre** for providing swimming facilities, and the current club site says Bushey is "primarily based at Bushey Grove Leisure Centre". The club's welcome pack adds that it uses pool facilities at **Bushey Grove Leisure Centre** and **St Margaret's**. What I could not verify publicly is the exact date when the club moved away from its original King George V pool base, or whether that was a single relocation or a sequence of pool changes.

The club's public naming has some continuity and some variation. The current official style is **Bushey Amateur Swimming Club**, commonly abbreviated **BASC** on archived documents, while local news coverage in 2016 also used **Bushey Swimming Club** in running text. That supports the interpretation that the core identity remained continuous even if public-facing shorthand varied. I found no authoritative public evidence of a formal legal name change, so it is safest to describe this as **variation in usage** rather than a verified renaming.

One of the clearest institutional milestones appears in the 2015 AGM papers. They record a major **club-structure reset** under Jack Jackson: more pool time across most groups, the planned development of a more senior squad, the introduction of a **swim4fitness** group, changes to club championships for older swimmers, and a move toward **licensed time trials**. The same minute also says 2015 had been a highly successful year competitively, with Bushey performing well in leagues, posting the most club records beaten ever, and sending the highest number of swimmers it had yet had to **Regionals**. The treasurer's report in the same minute attributes a financial loss partly to increased pool time and the introduction of a **paid coach**, another marker of organisational development.

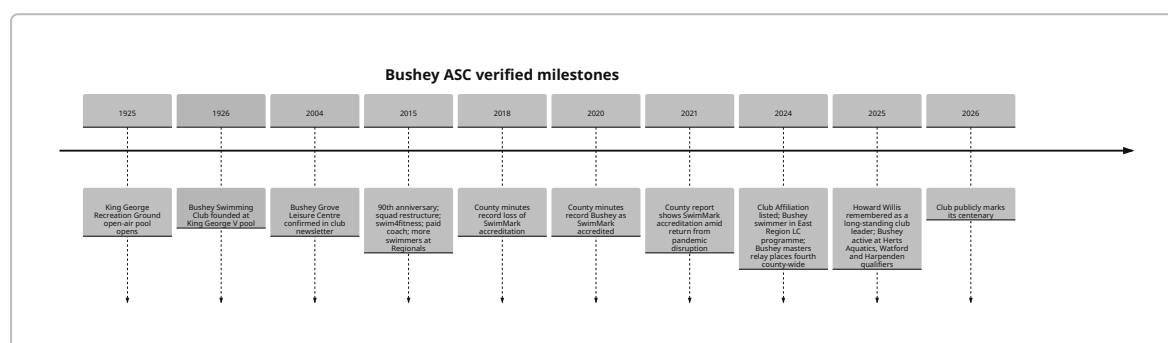
Governance and accreditation records show another useful milestone sequence. Hertfordshire county reporting lists Bushey as **swim21-accredited** in 2015, 2016 and 2017; county board minutes in January 2018 note that Bushey had **lost its SwimMark accreditation**; October 2020 minutes and the 2020–21 annual report then show Bushey as **SwimMark accredited** again; and the 2024 annual report lists Bushey not under SwimMark-accredited clubs but under **Club Affiliation**. That progression suggests a real shift in governance status over time rather than simple continuity.

On people, the publicly visible current leadership is straightforward: **Jane Willis** is listed as club president and **Oliver Spisak** as head coach. Historically, the 2015 AGM names **Wendy Cook** as club president, **Alan Brown** as acting chair, and **Jack Jackson** as the figure presenting the club's next five-year swimming plan. Jack Jackson also appears repeatedly in the club's 2016 achievement awards snippet, indicating that he was one of the club's leading swimmers of that period.

For notable swimmers, the public record is uneven. A 2016 Bushey news feature says the club had, in recent years, seen swimmers compete at the **Commonwealth Games**, had a swimmer reach a **Team GB Olympic trial**, and had "most recently" had a swimmer compete in the **European Masters** at the London Olympic pool. However, the names of those swimmers were not identified in the accessible public sources surfaced here. More recent, named evidence includes **William Presland** appearing in the programme for the 2024 East Region Long Course Championships and Bushey's appearance in the 2024 Hertfordshire Masters results, where Bushey placed **fourth** in the mixed 160+ years 100m medley team.

A final recent historical note concerns continuity of long service. In November 2025 the club announced the death of **Howard Willis**, describing him as president, a long-standing official presence at awards and club events, and a longstanding source of institutional memory who had been looking forward to the centenary. That statement matters historically because it confirms that, by the eve of the centenary, Bushey still had active custodians of its longer club memory within its leadership circle.

The following timeline summarises the **best-evidenced milestones** reconstructed from club, county, regional and local-history sources.



Concise verified chronology

Date	Milestone	Why it matters	Source
July 1925	King George Recreation Ground open-air pool opened	Establishes the pool infrastructure that the club later used	
1926	Bushey Swimming Club founded at King George V pool	Earliest verified founding point and place	
July 2004	Bushey Grove Leisure Centre named in club newsletter	Earliest accessible evidence of the modern operating base	
2015	90th anniversary announced at AGM	Confirms 1926 origin from an internal club record	
2015	New structure introduced, including swim4fitness and licensed time-trial plans	Major programme and pathway reform	
2015	"Most number of swimmers competing at Regionals" reported	Marks a competitive high point in the accessible record	
January 2018	County minutes note Bushey lost SwimMark	Important governance/ accreditation change	
October 2020 / 2021 report	Bushey listed as SwimMark accredited	Shows recovery of accreditation status	
2024	Bushey listed under Club Affiliation rather than SwimMark	Indicates present governance status in county reporting	
2025	Howard Willis obituary note ties him directly to centenary memory	Evidence of leadership continuity into centenary year	

Date	Milestone	Why it matters	Source
2026	Centenary page live	Confirms the club's present centenary self-understanding	

Competitive fixtures dataset

The dataset below is intentionally **conservative**. It includes only events for which I found a reasonably direct Bushey trace: a Bushey calendar listing, Bushey's own social or news post, a county accepted-entry file, a regional programme with Bushey swimmers, a licensed-meets listing for Bushey's own internal meets, or an organiser's results file showing Bushey competitors. The 2021 season was structurally disrupted because Hertfordshire reported that county and regional championships did not take place during the pandemic period. Also, Bushey's current fixtures page exposes only the heading and not the embedded detail via text extraction, while an older indexed calendar page preserves many 2024 entries in search snippets.

Multi-year event dataset

Year	Date	Event	Level	Team or individual	Evidence of Bushey participation	Source
2021	7 Nov 2021	Bushey Amateur SC Club Champs 2	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Swim England licensed-meets calendar	
2021	20–21 Nov 2021	Watford SC County Qualifier Open Meet	Local open / county-qualifier pathway	Individual	Results show Bushey swimmers including Alex Twyford and Emily Presland	
2021	12 Dec 2021	Bushey Amateur SC Club Champs 3	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Swim England licensed-meets calendar	
2022	5–6 Mar 2022	Watford SC Regional Qualifier	Local open / qualifier	Individual	Accepted entries show 66 Bushey individual entries; results show multiple Bushey swimmers	
2022	13 Mar 2022	Bushey Amateur SC Club Champs 1	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Swim England licensed-meets calendar	

Year	Date	Event	Level	Team or individual	Evidence of Bushey participation	Source
2022	20 Mar 2022	Bushey Amateur SC Time Trials 1	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Swim England licensed-meets calendar	
2022	12 Jun 2022	Bushey Amateur SC Club Champs 800/1500 Free	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Swim England licensed-meets calendar	
2022	10 Jul 2022	SSC Summer Sprint 2022	Development open meet	Individual	Stevenage results include several Bushey swimmers	
2022	30 Oct 2022	Swim England National Masters 2022	National	Individual / masters club points	National masters points sheet lists Bushey ASC	
2022	4-6 Nov 2022	Swim England East Region Short Course Championships	Regional	Individual	East Region programme includes Bushey swimmer Daniel Ord	
2023	Jan-Feb 2023	Swim England Hertfordshire County Championships 2023	County	Individual and team relays	Accepted entries list Bushey swimmers; club social also showcases 2023 counties and a championship team placing third	
2023	8-9 Jul 2023	Stevenage Summer Sprint / development meet	Development open meet	Individual	Club social advertises Stevenage meet for 8 July 2023; official results show Bushey swimmers and wins	
2023	13 Jul 2023	Swim England East Region Open Water Championships	Regional / county open water	Individual	Programme includes Bushey swimmer Barnaby O'Donnell	

Year	Date	Event	Level	Team or individual	Evidence of Bushey participation	Source
2023	late Jun / early Jul 2023	Peanuts League final	County league	Team	Official club Facebook reel announces Bushey finished third	
2023	18 Nov 2023	Arena League Round 2	League	Team	Official club Facebook reel posted 19 Nov 2023 says "last night at Arena League Round 2"	
2024	20 Apr 2024	Major League Round 3	County league	Team	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	21 Apr 2024	Time Trials 1	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	4-6 May 2024	Swim England East Region Long Course Championships	Regional	Individual	East Region programme includes Bushey swimmer William Presland	
2024	11 May 2024	Peanuts League Round 1	County league	Team	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	12 May 2024	Club Champs 2	Club / internal	Individual	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	18-19 May 2024	Watford Development Meet	Development open meet	Individual	Bushey listed in programme / entry documentation; also on Bushey's 2024 calendar	

Year	Date	Event	Level	Team or individual	Evidence of Bushey participation	Source
2024	8 Jun 2024	Peanuts League Round 2	County league	Team	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	15-16 Jun 2024	Watford Terry Davies Legacy Meet	Open meet	Individual	Bushey listed in programme; results show Bushey swimmers	
2024	29 Jun 2024	Peanuts League Round 3	County league	Team	Bushey's 2024 calendar and Hertfordshire Swimming League notice align on late-June round 3	
2024	9 Nov 2024	Arena League Round 2	League	Team	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	14 Dec 2024	Arena League Round 3	League	Team	Listed on Bushey's indexed 2024 calendar	
2024	mid-2024	Hertfordshire Masters competition	County masters	Individual and relay	Entry and results files show Bushey swimmers plus a mixed 160+ relay placing fourth	
2025	Jan 2025	Swim England Hertfordshire County Championships 2025	County	Individual	Accepted entries include several Bushey swimmers across multiple events	

Year	Date	Event	Level	Team or individual	Evidence of Bushey participation	Source
2025	1–2 Nov 2025	Hertfordshire Aquatics Open Meet	Local open / county-qualifier pathway	Individual	Official event page states dates; Bushey's own site carries a post titled "Great performances at Herts Aquatics"	
2025	15–16 Nov 2025	Watford County Qualifier Open Meet	Local open / county-qualifier pathway	Individual	Official results show Bushey swimmer Arthur Walden; Bushey's site highlights the meet	
2025	29 Nov 2025	Club Champs 3	Club / internal	Individual	Listed in Bushey's latest-news feed	
2025	7 Dec 2025	Harpenden Last Chance County Qualifier	Local open / county-qualifier pathway	Individual	Bushey's latest-news feed names the gala; Harpenden psych sheet includes Bushey swimmers	

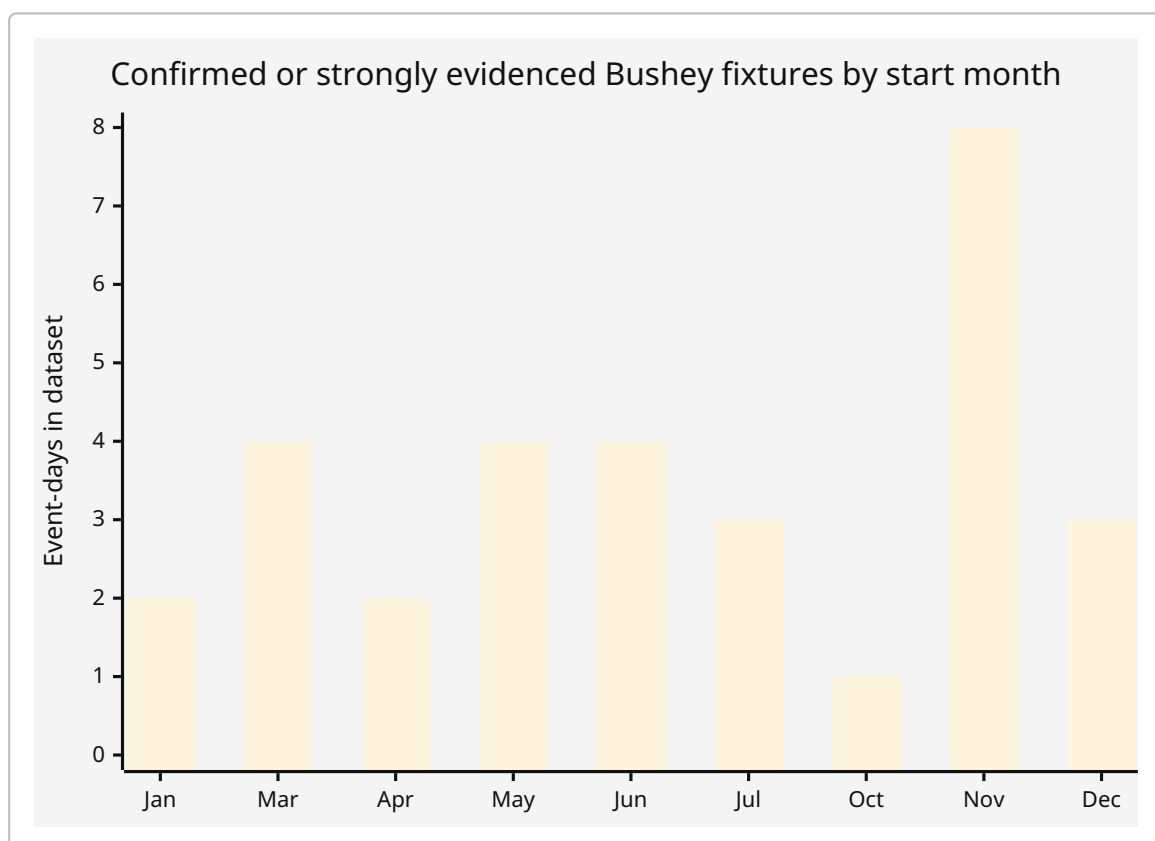
Event families and recurrence

Event family	Confirmed or strongly evidenced Bushey appearances in dataset	Typical month	Actual meet level	Team or individual	Interpretation
Bushey internal club championships / time trials	8 clear instances	March, April, June, November, December	Club / Level 4 internal	Individual	This is the backbone of the club's racing calendar and developmental assessment structure

Event family	Confirmed or strongly evidenced Bushey appearances in dataset	Typical month	Actual meet level	Team or individual	Interpretation
Watford-hosted open meets	5	March, May, June, November	Development / open / county-qualifier pathway	Individual	The most recurrent external meet host in the evidence base
Hertfordshire County Championships	2 confirmed entry years, plus 2024 county event clearly held	January	County	Individual and some relays	A central annual target meet; 2024 entry evidence for Bushey is indirect, so I keep the count conservative
Stevenage development / sprint meets	2	July	Development open meet	Individual	Rekurs as a development-focused summer fixture
East Region championships / open water	3	May, July, November	Regional	Individual	Bushey reaches regional level, but only for a subset of swimmers
Peanuts League rounds / final	At least 4 event-days evidenced	May, June, early July	County league	Team	Strong sign of structured competition for younger swimmers
Major League / Arena League rounds	At least 4 event-days evidenced	April, November, December	League	Team	Suggests Bushey fields team-based league squads beyond novice level
Hertfordshire Aquatics Open Meet	1 confirmed year	November	Open meet	Individual	Functions as an autumn county-qualifying opportunity

Event family	Confirmed or strongly evidenced Bushey appearances in dataset	Typical month	Actual meet level	Team or individual	Interpretation
Harpenden Last Chance County Qualifier	1 confirmed year	December	County-qualifier open meet	Individual	A final pre-counties time-chasing meet
Masters competition	2	mid-year / autumn	County masters and national masters	Individual and relay	Confirms an adult masters strand within the club

The chart below counts each distinct event date-range in the conservative dataset above once, by **start month**. It makes Bushey's public competition rhythm visually obvious: **January counties, spring-to-early-summer accumulation**, and a particularly dense **November to early-December** qualifying window. The heavy November bar is driven by the concentration of internal racing, team league rounds, and county-qualifier open meets.



Estimated annual calendar

The table below is a **best-estimate annual Bushey ASC calendar for the next season**, built from the recurring patterns above rather than from a fully accessible official fixture list for the future season. I have kept the estimates close to what is actually evidenced in 2024–2026 fixture material. Where I infer

rather than verify, I say so. Swimmer-level labels are inferred from meet level, qualifying structures, accepted-entry patterns, and the way the club itself describes its pathway from general club competition into counties and regionals.

Likely Bushey ASC annual cycle

Month	Likely event	Probable timing	Level	Team or individual	Likely swimmer level	Evidence / link
January	Hertfordshire County Championships	Mid to late January across two weekends	County	Individual and some relays	County A / County B, plus any swimmers with county QT/CT	
February	No strongly recurring public Bushey fixture surfaced	—	—	—	Training / qualification build phase likely, but not evidenced strongly enough to list a meet	—
March	Hertfordshire Major League Round 1 and Round 2	Early and late March	County league	Team	Development to county-standard club swimmers; team-selected	
March	Bushey Club Champs / Time Trials block	Mid to late March	Club / internal	Individual	Novice through county-level club members	
April	Hertfordshire Major League Round 3	Late April	County league	Team	Development to county-standard club swimmers; team-selected	
April	Bushey Time Trials 1	Mid to late April	Club / internal	Individual	Broad club usage, including newer racers and tracking swimmers	
April	Stevenage Development Meet	Mid-April	Development open meet	Individual	Novice / development / early county-aspirant swimmers	

Month	Likely event	Probable timing	Level	Team or individual	Likely swimmer level	Evidence / link
late April to May	Swim England East Region Long Course Championships	Late April to early May	Regional	Individual	Regional qualifiers only	
May	Peanuts League Round 1	Early to mid-May	County league	Team	Younger competitive swimmers, especially 9–12 age range	
May	Bushey Club Champs 2	Mid-May	Club / internal	Individual	Whole-club racing progression	
May	Watford Development Meet	Mid to late May	Development open meet	Individual	Novice / development / County B aspirants	
June	Peanuts League Round 2	Early June	County league	Team	Younger competitive swimmers, especially 9–12 age range	
June	Watford Terry Davies Legacy Meet	Mid-June	Open meet	Individual	Stronger age-group swimmers from County A up to regional-development standard	
June	Peanuts League Round 3	Late June	County league	Team	Younger competitive swimmers, especially 9–12 age range	
June	Bushey long-distance club champs	Early to mid-June	Club / internal	Individual	Endurance-oriented club swimmers; county-distance aspirants	

Month	Likely event	Probable timing	Level	Team or individual	Likely swimmer level	Evidence / link
July	Stevenage Summer Sprint or equivalent local summer meet	Early July	Development open meet	Individual	Development / age-group swimmers needing race reps	
July	East Region / county open water	Mid-July, qualification permitting	Regional / county open water	Individual	Open-water capable age-group swimmers with interest and qualification	
August	No stable recurring public fixture surfaced	—	—	—	Likely lighter racing period	—
September	Autumn open meet possible, but Bushey participation is less directly evidenced	Early September	Open meet	Individual	County-qualifying and early-season sharpener swimmers	The county itself advertised a September Hertfordshire Aquatics Autumn Open Meet in 2023 county programmes, but I did not find direct Bushey proof for September participation every year.
October	Arena League Round 1	Early to mid-October	League	Team	Team-selected club swimmers, generally older development and age-group depth swimmers	Date pattern published nationally for Arena rounds; Bushey's own recent evidence shows later rounds and league involvement.

Month	Likely event	Probable timing	Level	Team or individual	Likely swimmer level	Evidence / link
November	Hertfordshire Aquatics Open Meet	First weekend of November	Open meet	Individual	County A / County B / regional-development swimmers chasing short-course times	
November	Watford County Qualifier	Mid-November	County-qualifier open meet	Individual	County aspirants and established county swimmers seeking refinement before entries close	
November	Bushey Club Champs 3	Late November	Club / internal	Individual	Whole-club progression and annual awards cycle support	
November	Arena League Round 2	Early to mid-November	League	Team	Team-selected swimmers, mostly established club racers	
December	Harpenden Last Chance County Qualifier	First weekend of December	County-qualifier open meet	Individual	Last-chance county qualifiers and swimmers close to QT/CT standards	
December	Arena League Round 3	Early to mid-December	League	Team	Team-selected swimmers, mostly established club racers	

How swimmer-level inference was made

The swimmer-level labels above are not copied from Bushey documents; they are an evidence-based inference. **Club Champs** and **Time Trials** were treated as broad-access internal meets because they are Bushey-run, Level 4-style club fixtures and are paired on club materials with general development work. **Peanuts League** was classified as a younger-swimmer team series because Hertfordshire league information and external league descriptions describe it as a distinct league format, and one official

description states that swimmers aged **9 to 12** contest mixed individual and relay events. **County Championships** were treated as County A/B and above because county documentation relies on qualifying and consideration times. **Regional** events were reserved for swimmers who have already moved beyond county level. **Watford Development, Watford County Qualifier, Harpenden Last Chance, Stevenage Summer Sprint, and Hertfordshire Aquatics Open Meet** sit mostly in the development-to-county-qualifier corridor, with the Terry Davies meet pushing further toward stronger age-group and regional-development swimmers.

Methodology and evidential limits

I searched five source families. First, I used **Bushey ASC's current website** for official self-description, leadership, centenary wording, and current-news references. Second, I used **Bushey ASC's archived AGM and policy files** where available, because they are the richest source for institutional history and programme change. Third, I used **Swim England Hertfordshire** for county accepted entries, annual reports, warm-up documents, and competition pages. Fourth, I used **Swim England East Region and Swimming Results / Licensed Meets** for regional-entry evidence and for Bushey's own licensed internal fixtures. Fifth, I used **official organiser result or programme PDFs** from Watford, Stevenage, Harpenden and county masters pages to confirm Bushey entries. Only after that did I supplement with **official club social snippets** and **local news / local-history** sources where the main official record was incomplete.

The most important evidential problem is that Bushey's current **Upcoming Fixtures** page does not expose its embedded event detail cleanly to text extraction; the accessible output shows the page title and heading, but not the actual date list. An older Bushey calendar page, however, is still indexed and its search-result snippets preserve substantial chunks of the **2024 fixture structure**, which is why several 2024 event identifications come from search snippets rather than a fully open page. That is not ideal, but it is still a direct Bushey source.

On the history side, the biggest unresolved questions are **founders' names, the exact chronology of pool relocations**, and the **named identities of the Commonwealth Games / Olympic-trial / European Masters swimmers** mentioned in 2016 local coverage. The existence of those milestone-level achievements is publicly attested, but the named biographies behind them did not surface in the indexed material I could access. That is why the historical section above is strongest on **date, place, governance, programme and competition-pathway milestones**, and more cautious on individual biographies.

The competitive dataset should therefore be read as a **minimum verified dataset**, not as a complete meet-by-meet log of every Bushey appearance in the last five seasons. In practice, Bushey almost certainly raced more often than this report can prove from public sources alone. I have erred on the side of excluding meets unless I found a direct Bushey trace, and I have labelled a few items as **scheduled / strongly evidenced** rather than over-stating them as fully results-confirmed. That conservative approach is the reason the report is rigorous, but it also means some genuine Bushey fixtures will remain outside the table.
